



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Communication Skills

HUMAN RESOURCES MANAGEMENT SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the nature of staff communication.
2. Employ communication styles appropriate to the target audience.
3. Choose and use appropriate channels for workplace communication.
4. Explain how digital communications exposes business to risk.
5. Distinguish between using social media for business and personal purposes.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the Director of Communications for GROWTH COACHING SERVICES, a consulting firm that provides professional development and coaching services for small business owners. The firm has a client base of over 500 businesses across various industries, including retail, technology, and healthcare. GROWTH COACHING SERVICES offers personalized coaching programs, workshops, and online webinars that help business owners develop leadership skills, enhance team productivity, and improve business operations.

Recently, a coach working for GROWTH COACHING SERVICES was mentioned in a social media post by a client. The client posted a negative review on TikTok, criticizing the coach for providing "generic advice" and "failing to offer any real solutions." The tweet gained significant attention, leading to multiple retweets and comments from other clients who expressed similar dissatisfaction.

The CEO of GROWTH COACHING SERVICES (judge) is concerned about the potential damage to the company's reputation and has asked you to develop a communication strategy in response to the situation. The CEO wants you to address the following:

- How to respond to the negative social media post in a way that mitigates reputational harm.
- How to engage with other clients who are expressing concerns on social media.
- What steps the company should take internally to prevent similar issues from happening in the future.
- How to balance transparency and professionalism in addressing the concerns publicly.

You will present your recommendations to the CEO (judge) in a meeting to take place in the CEO's office. The CEO (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your recommendations and answered the CEO's (judge's) questions, the CEO (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. What specific strategies would you recommend for engaging with other clients who have joined in the criticism?
2. If the issue continues to escalate on social media, what further steps would you take to manage the crisis and prevent any long-term damage to the company's brand?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the nature of staff communication?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Employ communication styles appropriate to the target audience?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Choose and use appropriate channels for workplace communication?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Explain how digital communications exposes business to risk?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Distinguish between using social media for business and personal purposes?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						